

**The five-minute
check that tells
you where the
gap is.**

Ask them to explain, not to solve

Give a question they got right and ask why the method works. Fluency without understanding shows up in seconds, and it is the single best early warning.

Go back two years, not two weeks

Set a question from Year 7 fractions. If it is slow or uncertain, you have found the floor, and no amount of Year 10 revision will fix it.

Watch where they stop, not what they answer

The pause tells you more than the mark. Children hesitate exactly at the topic they never closed.

Do it without a grade attached

The moment it feels like a test, you measure anxiety instead of knowledge. Keep it casual and the information is far better.



**Try this tonight. It
takes five minutes.**

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